Australian Government | eSafetyCommissioner

Threads

Minimum age for Australians (under Social Media Minimum Age law)

What is Threads?

Threads is a social media platform developed by Meta. It is similar to X ([esafety.gov.au/key-topics/esafety-guide/x] Twitter) [esafety.gov.au/key-topics/esafety-guide/x] . The app allows you to post text, links, photos, videos (up to five minutes long), and polls. Threads posts can include up to 500 characters in the main post text. You can also add a longer text attachment of up to 10,000 characters if you need more space. You can like, repost, reply to or quote a 'thread', and the number of likes and replies a post receives is shown.

You must have an Instagram [esafety.gov.au/key-topics/esafety-guide/instagram] account to log in and adhere to Instagram's Community Guidelines on behaviour. You can unfollow, block, restrict and report a profile, and you can also control who can mention you and filter out replies that contain certain words.

Threads accounts are open to the public by default unless you are 16 (or 18 in certain countries), in which case your account will be set to private by default. You can choose to make your account public or private, meaning it is only visible to people you follow. Using Threads is free but a lot of personal data on users is collected.

Website:threads.net [threads.net/]
Apps: Android app [play.google.com/store/apps/details] , Apple iOS app [apps.apple.com/au/app/threads-an-instagram-app/id6446901002]

How do people use Threads?

Learn more about the benefits and risks associated with how people use content sharing services like Threads.

Threads is used for: content creation [esafety.gov.au/key-topics/online-tools-and-features/content-creation], location sharing [esafety.gov.au/key-issues/esafety-guide/location-sharing], messaging/online chat [esafety.gov.au/key-issues/esafety-guide/messaging-online-chat], online relationships [esafety.gov.au/key-issues/esafety-guide/online-relationships], photo/video sharing [esafety.gov.au/key-issues/esafety-guide/photo-video-sharing] and screen capture [esafety.gov.au/key-topics/online-tools-and-features/screen-capture].

Social media age restrictions for under-16s

As of 4 December 2025 [medium.com/meta-australia-policy-blog/removing-access-to-instagram-threads-and-facebook-for-under-16s-in-australia-1ab448660c0f], Australians under 16 should no longer be able to access their Threads accounts or create a new account. This change is in response to the Australian Government's social media age restrictions [esafety.gov.au/about-us/industry-regulation/social-media-age-restrictions-hub].

Users aged 16 and older who mistakenly receive a notification or lose access to their accounts have the option to confirm their age through Meta's third-party partner, Yoti, by providing a video selfie or government-issued ID. Yoti deletes this information once the age check is complete.

These links are provided by Threads:

- About the changes [help.instagram.com/1540022163905971]

Find out about what this means for Australian users under 16.

- How does video selfie age verification work on Threads? [help.instagram.com/292521846402382]
  Advice about how to have your age verified on Threads.
- Report an underage user [help.instagram.com/contact/275701768225412/]
  How to report an underage user on Threads.
- Review and export a copy of your Threads information [help.instagram.com/259803026523198/]
  How to download your Threads posts and account information.

How can you report online abuse, ask for content to be removed or block someone?

These links are provided by Threads:

- Safety and reporting [help.instagram.com/179980294969821]
  Advice on how to report something, remove a follower or block someone on Threads is on the Threads help page.
- Restrict someone [help.instagram.com/179980294969821]
  Advice on how to restrict someone, meaning you won't receive any more notifications about that person even if they like, reply, repost or quote your content, is on the Threads help page.

How can you moderate comments and tagging?

These links are provided by Threads:

- Manage who can mention you [help.instagram.com/179980294969821]
  Advice on how to choose who can mention you is on the Threads help page.
- Hide replies that you don't want to see on Threads [help.instagram.com/179980294969821]
  Advice on how to filter out common offensive words or add

custom words to hide replies that contain these words is on the Threads help page.

How can you protect your personal information?

This link is provided by Threads:

- Manage your privacy, visibility and account settings [help.instagram.com/179980294969821]
  The Threads help page has advice on how to switch your profile to private and manage privacy settings. There is also advice on keeping your account secure.

Key safety links

These links are provided by Threads:

- Instagram’s community guidelines [help.instagram.com/477434105621119]
  The community guidelines you should adhere to when using Threads.
- Instagram's terms of use [help.instagram.com/581066165581870]
  Instagram’s terms of use which also apply to Threads.
- Supplemental terms of use [help.instagram.com/769983657850450]
  The Terms of Use specific to Threads.
- Meta's privacy policy [privacycenter.instagram.com/policy]
  The privacy policy for Meta products including Instagram and Threads.
- Supplemental privacy policy [help.instagram.com/515230437301944]
  The supplemental privacy policy specific to Threads.
- Disabled Threads accounts [help.instagram.com/494292066734215]
  Learn more about what to do if you think your Threads account was disabled by mistake.

Last updated: 20/08/2026

Social media changes

From 10 December 2025, certain social media platforms are not allowed to let Australian children under 16 create or keep an account.

Find out more at eSafety's social media age restrictions hub.

About The eSafety Guide

The eSafety Guide helps you find out how to protect your personal information and report harmful content on common social media, games, apps and sites. Entries are for information only and are not reviews, endorsements or assessments against any legislative definition by eSafety. Before choosing to use any online service or platform it's best to:

- do your own research to understand the risks and benefits
- check the age rating and requirements
- consider privacy
- check the permissions and other settings
- check the in-app reporting options.

If you are a parent or carer who is deciding whether a child should be allowed to use an online service or platform, you can also:

- consider your child's readiness for the types of content and experiences they might encounter
- help them understand what to do if they need help
- provide ongoing support and monitoring, for example through regular check-ins with your child
- agree to some rules about use of each service or platform.

To find out more, you can read the App checklist for parents, as well as information about parental controls in social media, games and apps and mental wellbeing resources for families.